

EXTREME WAYS

THE NEWEST MEMBER OF THE XTREME LINE-UP IS HERO'S MOST POWERFUL MOTORCYCLE IN INDIA

BY ABHINAV JHAKAR

HERO XTREME 250R

HARVINDER SINGH

Recently, we got a chance to sample the newest member of Hero MotoCorp's Xtreme family, which is supposed to compete in the 250cc segment. It's called the Xtreme 250R and is completely new from the ground up.

If I had to use one word to describe the 250R's design language, it would have to be aggressive. Another word would be aspirational. Overall, though, Hero must be commended for the design adopted not just for the 250R, but the whole Xtreme line-up. The 250R is based on a trellis frame and features a 50-50 weight distribution between the front and rear. Then there's the 249 cc, single-cylinder, liquid-cooled, four-valve, DOHC motor derived from the Karizma XMR 210 cc motor. However, Hero has completely reworked the internals and made several important changes. For example, the bump in capacity comes from a different crank, and the Hero team says there is reduced friction thanks to a DLC-coated valve train. It also makes use of semi-dry-sump lubrication, and heat management has also been reworked so that it drives hot air away from the rider's legs. Now, that motor mentioned above produces 30 bhp of peak power and 25Nm of peak torque, which makes it Hero MotoCorp's most powerful model on sale in India.

Hero Xtreme 250R
Engine: 249 cc, single-cylinder, liquid-cooled, four-valve, DOHC
Power: 30 bhp@9,250rpm
Torque: 25Nm@7,250rpm
Gearbox: 6-speed
Price: ₹1.80 lakh (ex-showroom)
On sale now

On starting, there's a distinct beat from the exhaust, which feels throaty yet refined. The power delivery in the low-end is mild, but around the mid-range mark, which is around the 4,000 to 5,000 rpm range, things begin to liven up. There's another sudden burst of energy around 7,000 rpm, which feels helpful when one needs a quick overtake. At 75-80 kmph, this bike sits at under 5,000 rpm, which is a great set-up for a motorcycle that will mostly be ridden in city conditions. Hero's ace-in-the-hole with the Xtreme 250R has to be the ride quality and handling. There's a hint of stiffness, but it still gobbles up bad roads commendably, without feeling crashy or overburdened. That short wheelbase means that this motorcycle handles like a charm, and is probably the best out of Hero's entire stable.

The Xtreme 250R is priced at Rs 1.80 lakh (ex-showroom), which is good since it undercuts its main rivals—the Suzuki Gixxer 250 and KTM 250 Duke—comfortably. There are three colour options to choose from, and my favourite of the lot has to be the 'Stealth Black', which looks properly menacing. In conclusion, Hero MotoCorp's Xtreme line-up feels more complete with the 250R and is a perfect motorcycle for those looking for an upgrade. ■